IT Services Sector

What is behind the rise in cyberattacks on Japanese companies?

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Japan Equity Research
IT Services and Telecoms
Matthew Henderson AC
(81-3) 6736-8831
matthew.henderson@jpmorgan.com
JPMorgan Securities Japan Co., Ltd.

We had expected the frequency of cyberattacks on companies to rise in line with the malicious use of AI, but we have a strong impression that reports of cyber incidents involving Japanese companies have become more frequent since September 2026. In addition, Japanese security-related stocks (Figure 1) have also risen since August 2026, and we think investors are selecting stocks that benefit from security demand. We tallied the number of corporate incident reports (new ones only) published by ScanNetSecurity on a monthly basis (Figure 2). The number in September, 62, was the highest in the past three years, and the figure for October is on track to reach 85 based on the 17 already reported as of October 6. We think Japanese companies have become more vulnerable targets because the language barrier no longer functions as a sort of firewall, thanks to generative AI, and as a result, the weakness of Japanese companies' security measures has become apparent (see our June 26 report). However, geopolitical risks may also be having an impact, as recent trends give us the impression that a wide range of cyberattacks other than sophisticated ransomware attacks are becoming more common (Figure 3).

- The three cybersecurity-related stocks in our coverage are Trend Micro (4704; Neutral), Nomura Research Institute (4307; Overweight), and Otsuka Corporation (4768; Underweight). 1) Trend Micro develops enterprise security software, but its domestic ARR growth is limited. ARR has accelerated in AMEA and Europe (see our September 2 report), but we think major US security software companies are still increasing their share of Japan's market. 2) Nomura Research Institute is focusing on its security business, and we think security solutions contribute fairly substantially to earnings for an SIer. Human capital capacity is a growth constraint for SIers, but we like the company's positioning, specifically its strengths in the financial sector and extensive track record in security operations. 3) Sales of Otsuka Corporation's security-related products (OSM: Otsuka Security Management) have been strong thanks to rising security demand (see our August 27 report). The SCS evaluation system (for rating corporate IT infrastructure measures) to be implemented in 2H FY2026 could boost security demand from SMEs, which make up Otsuka's customer base.

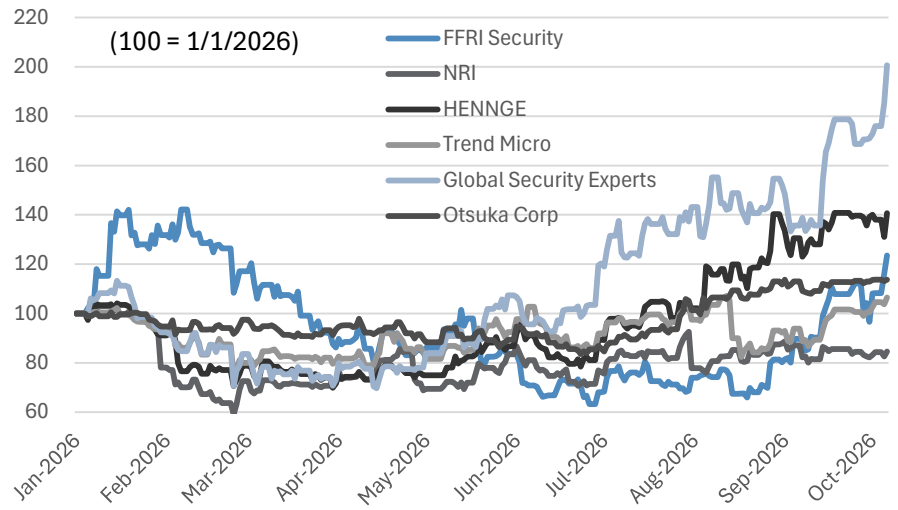
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JPMorgan Securities Japan Co., Ltd.
Matthew Henderson [AC]
(81-3) 6736-8831
matthew.henderson@jpmorgan.com

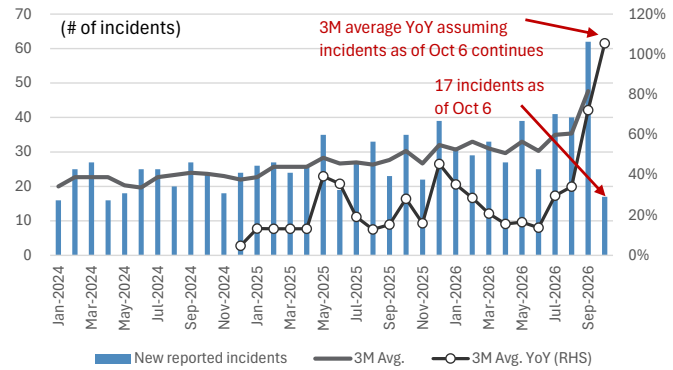
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Figure 1: Domestic security-related companies' share price trend



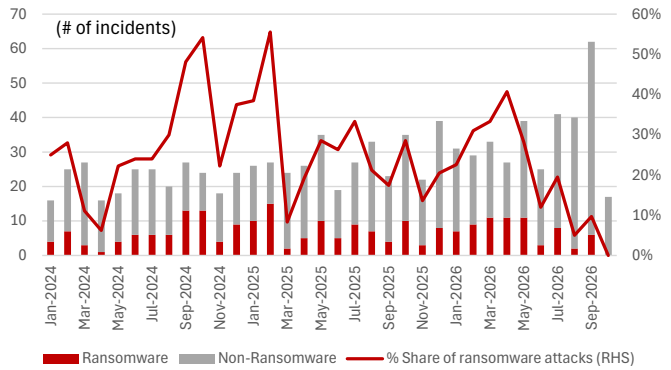
Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan

Figure 2: Reported domestic cyber attack incidents



Note: We complied the frequency of new reports from ScanNetSecurity. October 2026 incidents as of October 6.
Source: ScanNetSecurity, J.P. Morgan

Figure 3: Ransomware frequency among domestic cyber attacks



Note: We complied the frequency of new reports from ScanNetSecurity. October 2026 incidents as of October 6.
Source: ScanNetSecurity, J.P. Morgan

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JPMorgan Securities Japan Co., Ltd.
Matthew Henderson [AC]
(81-3) 6736-8831
matthew.henderson@jpmorgan.com

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Figure 4: Security policies of Japan

Policy	Timeline	Content	Expected Market Impact
Active Cyber Defense Act	Enacted May 2025; neutralization measures begin October 2026; full enforcement by November 2027	National Cyber Command Center serves as control tower. Utilizes communication data from critical infrastructure to access and neutralize attack-origin servers	Strengthening of reporting and coordination systems for critical infrastructure operators
Unified Standards for Critical Infrastructure	Decided July 2026; enforcement scheduled for October	Common requirements across 16 sectors: executive-level risk management, CSIRT, supply chain management, vulnerability management, log monitoring, incident reporting, and BCP	SOC, log infrastructure, and vulnerability management become mandatory budget items for designated companies
SCS Rating System (METI)	Operations begin in the second half of FY2026; 5-star ratings from FY2027	Rates IT infrastructure measures of business partners at 3 (expert-confirmed monthly self-assessment) and 4 (third-party evaluation)	Increasing demand for business partners to obtain SCS ratings
Amendment to the Act on the Protection of Personal Information	Promulgated July 2026; full enforcement by July 2028	Introduces surcharges for serious violations; strengthens oversight and penalties	Increase in security-related expenditures
Project YATA-Shield	In preparation	Countermeasures against misuse risks of frontier AI models. A domestic initiative similar to "Project Glasswing," including AI-driven vulnerability discovery and remediation	Boosting demand for sovereign AI and promoting corporate use of AI for security

Source: National Cybersecurity Office, J.P. Morgan

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JPMorgan Securities Japan Co., Ltd.
Matthew Henderson AC
(81-3) 6736-8831
matthew.henderson@jpmorgan.com

Asia Pacific Equity Research
07 October 2026

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Companies Discussed in This Report (all prices in this report as of market close on 06 October 2026, unless otherwise indicated)
Nomura Research Institute (4307)(4307.T/¥5,090/OW), Otsuka Corporation (4768)(4768.T/¥3,675/UW), Trend Micro (4704)(4704.T/¥6,928/N)

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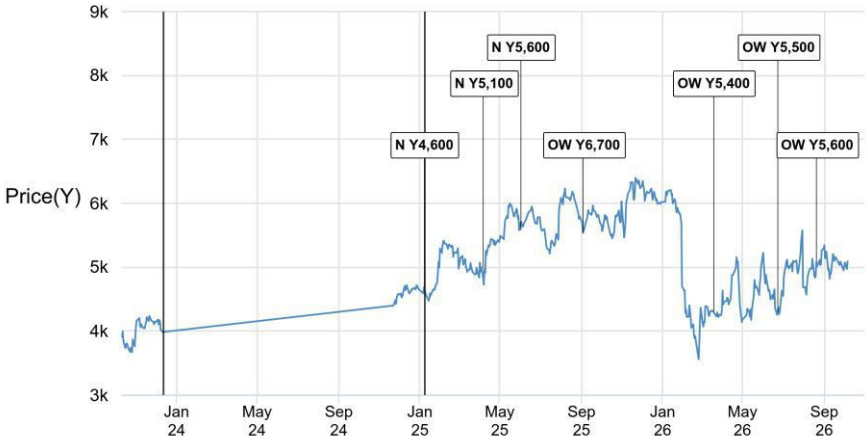
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Matthew Henderson [AC]
(81-3) 6736-8831
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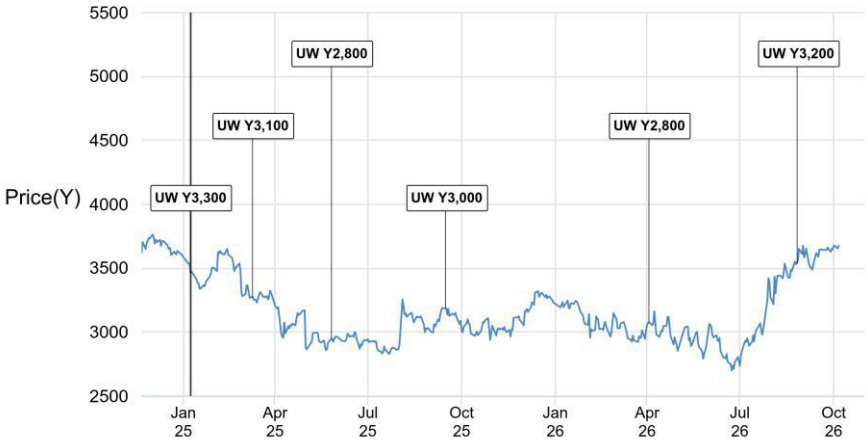
Nomura Research Institute (4307) (4307.T, 4307 JP) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Jul 03, 2006. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.
Break in coverage Dec 11, 2023 - Jan 08, 2025.

Date	Rating	Price (Y)	Price Target (Y)
08-Jan-25	N	4691	4,600
07-Apr-25	N	4995	5,100
02-Jun-25	N	5578	5,600
04-Sep-25	OW	5539	6,700
19-Mar-26	OW	4301	5,400
24-Jun-26	OW	4304	5,500
21-Aug-26	OW	5075	5,600

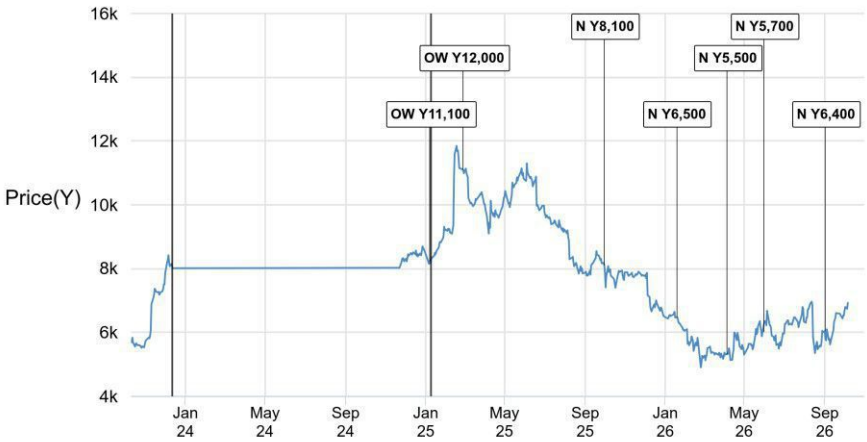
Otsuka Corporation (4768) (4768.T, 4768 JP) Price Chart



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Initiated coverage Oct 09, 2007. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.
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Date	Rating	Price (Y)	Price Target (Y)
08-Jan-25	UW	3538	3,300
10-Mar-25	UW	3268	3,100
27-May-25	UW	2944	2,800
16-Sep-25	UW	3188	3,000
03-Apr-26	UW	3073	2,800
27-Aug-26	UW	3539	3,200

Trend Micro (4704) (4704.T, 4704 JP) Price Chart



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28-Feb-25	OW	11100	12,000
01-Oct-25	N	8100	8,100
19-Jan-26	N	6467	6,500
06-Apr-26	N	5316	5,500
01-Jun-26	N	6010	5,700
02-Sep-26	N	6045	6,400

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JPMorgan Securities Japan Co., Ltd.
Matthew Henderson AC
(81-3) 6736-8831
matthew.henderson@jpmorgan.com

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JPMorgan Securities Japan Co., Ltd.
Matthew Henderson [AC]
(81-3) 6736-8831
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JPMorgan Securities Japan Co., Ltd.
Matthew Henderson AC
(81-3) 6736-8831
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